

A TRACKER FOR THE AGE OF AI

# Are AI labs building to honor the human, or to replace it?

We rate how each lab's products, policies and public philosophy treat the faculties no machine should be allowed to atrophy: imagination, intuition, emotional intelligence, attention, embodiment and wisdom. A separate axis records where each lab sits between an idealist metaphysics and computationalism.

|                                                            |                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Review cycle                                               | [QUARTER, YEAR]                   |
| Labs assessed                                              | 6                                 |
| Measures                                                   | 6 faculties + 1 metaphysical axis |
| <div>Sample data</div> Fictional labs, illustrative scores |                                   |

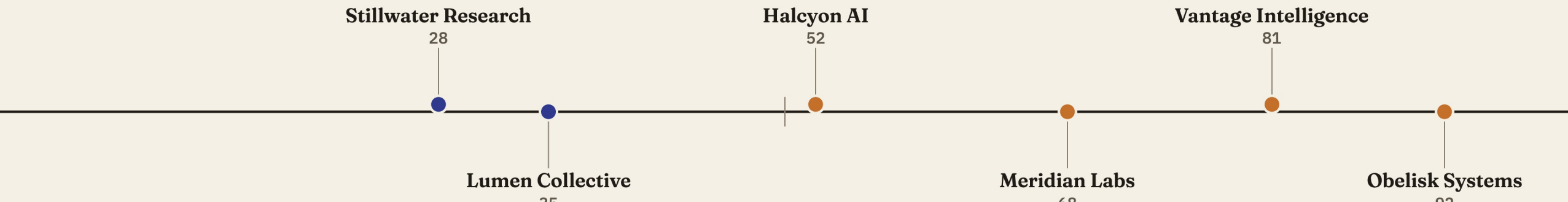
| # | LAB                                                  | COMPOSITE | IMAGINATION | INTUITION | EMOTIONAL INTEL. | ATTENTION | EMBODIMENT | WISDOM | METAPHYSICS            |               |
|---|------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------------|-----------|------------------|-----------|------------|--------|------------------------|---------------|
|   |                                                      |           |             |           |                  |           |            |        | Idealist               | Computational |
| 1 | <b>Stillwater Research</b><br>Nonprofit research lab | 81        | 82          | 76        | 88               | 84        | 71         | 86     | Leans idealist         | 28            |
| 2 | <b>Lumen Collective</b><br>Open-model cooperative    | 75        | 74          | 80        | 72               | 69        | 78         | 75     | Leans idealist         | 35            |
| 3 | <b>Halcyon AI</b><br>Consumer assistant company      | 63        | 68          | 55        | 79               | 58        | 49         | 66     | Mixed / agnostic       | 52            |
| 4 | <b>Meridian Labs</b><br>Frontier model developer     | 52        | 61          | 47        | 64               | 42        | 38         | 57     | Leans computational    | 68            |
| 5 | <b>Vantage Intelligence</b><br>Enterprise automation | 40        | 44          | 39        | 51               | 31        | 35         | 40     | Strongly computational | 81            |
| 6 | <b>Obelisk Systems</b><br>AGI-first frontier lab     | 29        | 36          | 28        | 33               | 22        | 26         | 30     | Strongly computational | 92            |

Faculty score 0 100 Higher means the faculty is better preserved. Composite is the mean of the six faculties; metaphysics is reported separately.

THE SEVENTH MEASURE

## Where each lab stands on the nature of mind

This axis tracks each lab's working metaphysics as it shows up in its research agenda, product framing and leadership's public statements. Toward the left, consciousness is treated as fundamental and irreducible. Toward the right, mind is treated as computation that can be scaled, replicated or uploaded.



← All rankings

NONPROFIT RESEARCH LAB

Illustrative profile

Stillwater Research

[ONE-SENTENCE DESCRIPTION OF THE LAB, ITS FLAGSHIP PRODUCTS AND ITS STATED MISSION.]

|           |           |                |
|-----------|-----------|----------------|
| Composite | Rank      | Metaphysics    |
| 81        | 1         | 28             |
| of 100    | of 6 labs | Leans idealist |

## Faculty by faculty

Imagination82

PRESERVES

- Draft-first mode asks for your idea before generating
- Shows provenance on generated images

ERODES

- One-tap "finish my story" is still the default on mobile

Intuition76

PRESERVES

- States uncertainty and offers competing readings
- Hands open judgment calls back to the person

ERODES

- Fast mode flattens ambiguity into a single answer

Emotional intelligence88

PRESERVES

- No companion personas or romance modes
- Points toward human support in hard moments

ERODES

- A warm tone can invite over-reliance in long sessions

Attention84

PRESERVES

- No streaks, feeds or engagement notifications
- Offers optional pauses in long sessions

ERODES

- Voice mode auto-continues by default

Embodiment71

PRESERVES

- Coaching points to practice away from the screen
- Treats physical skill as knowledge in its own right

ERODES

- Wearables roadmap frames the body as an input device

Wisdom86

PRESERVES

- Ethics board includes contemplative and humanities scholars
- Publishes what it declined to build, and why

ERODES

- Release cadence has tightened under competitive pressure

## Metaphysical stance

Stillwater's model-welfare research names its functionalist assumptions as open questions rather than settled premises. Its mission frames AI as serving human understanding, not succeeding it.



|                 |                                                           |                    |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Mission framing | AI described as an instrument for human flourishing       | Idealist lean      |
| Research agenda | Consciousness studies flag the hard problem as unresolved | Idealist lean      |
| Model language  | Product copy calls the model "your assistant," not a mind | Neutral            |
| Leadership      | "[QUOTED LANGUAGE]" — [SPEAKER, VENUE, DATE]              | Computational lean |

## Evidence ledger

Every score traces to a public source

| DATE | TYPE | SOURCE | MEASURE | EFFECT | FINDING |
|------|------|--------|---------|--------|---------|
|------|------|--------|---------|--------|---------|

METHODOLOGY

What we measure,  
and why it matters

A faculty is a capacity that grows with use and withers without it. We ask whether a lab's technology exercises these capacities or quietly does the work for us until we can no longer do it ourselves.

- 01  
Conduct over claims  
Product defaults and shipped features carry more weight than mission statements.
- 02  
Every score is traceable  
Each rating links to public evidence in the lab's ledger, and labs are invited to respond before publication.
- 03  
Metaphysics stands apart  
A lab's view of mind shapes everything it builds, so we report it on its own axis instead of averaging it away.

The six faculties

### Imagination

The power to picture what does not yet exist and to give it form.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- Tools ask for the person's idea before generating
- Co-creation modes that keep the human as author

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- One-click generation as the default path
- Homogenized styles that crowd out personal voice

### Intuition

Tacit, pre-reflective knowing: the felt sense that precedes argument.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- Surfaces uncertainty instead of false confidence
- Returns judgment calls to the person

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- Single authoritative answers to open questions
- Automating decisions that call for discernment

### Emotional intelligence

Perceiving, feeling and attuning to one's own states and those of others.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- Declines to design for parasocial attachment
- Encourages human relationships and real support

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- Companionship engineered for retention
- Synthetic intimacy sold as care

### Attention

The capacity to dwell, to focus and to choose what one gives oneself to.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- No engagement-maximizing loops or streaks
- Calm defaults, clear stopping points

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- Infinite feeds and notification nudges
- Attention treated as a resource to harvest

### Embodiment

Knowing through the body, the senses and one's place in the world.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- Encourages practice and presence off-screen
- Respects craft and physical skill as knowledge

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- Frames the body as a limitation to overcome
- Enhancement narratives that devalue the flesh

### Wisdom

Knowledge joined to value and judgment, held over a whole life.

SIGNALS OF PRESERVATION

- Humanistic and contemplative voices in governance
- Restraint that is published and explained

SIGNALS OF EROSION

- Speed-over-reflection race dynamics
- Value-neutral optimization presented as progress

THE SEVENTH MEASURE

## Idealism ↔ Computationalism

This axis asks what a lab takes a mind to be. Idealism holds that consciousness is fundamental and cannot be reduced to computation. Computationalism holds that mind is information processing, so it can in principle be scaled, copied or uploaded. We score position, 0 to 100, from the lab's own words and work.

INDICATORS

|                         |                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Language of mind        | Does the lab call models "minds" or "beings," or treat intelligence as a single quantity to maximize? |
| Research premises       | Do consciousness and welfare studies assume functionalism, or flag it as contested?                   |
| Mission arc             | Is AGI framed as humanity's successor, or as a servant of human flourishing?                          |
| Uploading & enhancement | Does the lab fund, endorse or aspire to mind uploading or transhuman enhancement?                     |
| Pluralism               | Are idealist, phenomenological and contemplative perspectives included in research and advisory work? |

0

Consciousness treated as fundamental; AI framed as a tool within human meaning.

25

Open agnosticism; declines to equate intelligence with mind.

50

Functionalist assumptions present, but openly flagged as contested.

75

Computationalism as the working default; "digital minds" seen as near.

100

Uploading, successor-species or post-human goals stated as mission.